

drivers for wireless, USB, ACPI, Bluetooth (ath3k), CPUFreq, HID, MD/RAID, MMC, DVB, PCI, SCSI, TTY, and XEN. The XFS, UDF, NFS, JFFS2, OCFS2, EXT4 and Btrfs file systems have also received several improvements, and some Ceph, IPv4 and SunRPC issues have also been fixed. The upcoming Ubuntu 15.04 (Vivid Vervet) will be based on the Linux 3.19 kernel, and it already includes packages based on the Linux kernel 3.19.1.

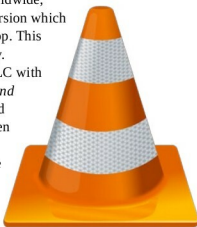
VLC 2.2 launched for Windows, Mac, Linux and leading mobile platforms

The favourite media player of millions worldwide, VLC, has released its 2.2 'Weathermax' version which integrates some new features for the desktop. This release includes a built-in extension gallery.

New features can be easily added to VLC with just a few clicks through *Tools > Plugins and Extensions*. The new version has also added the playback resume feature, which has been requested for some time. When a video or audio file is reopened, a 'Continue Playback' pop-up appears and in this way the desktop version comes on par with its mobile counterpart. Another major real-life bug has been resolved too, which used to auto-rotate videos that are recorded on a smartphone or tablet.

Some usual codec updates have also taken place like support for Ultra HD, VP9 and H.265, and 'compatibility' fixes for a series of obscure file formats. Some other changes include GPU zero-copy decoding, which will ensure faster performance levels, support for 'Digital Cinema Package' and support for interactive Blu-Ray menus too. If you are feeling bored, you can also play with its three new video filters: 'old movie', 'VHS effect' and 'freeze effect'.

VLC 2.2 can be downloaded and used for free on Windows, Mac, Linux and other mobile platforms including Windows Phones, Android and iOS. Ubuntu users can also upgrade or install it through the official VLC Personal Package Archives.



Mozilla Firefox 64-bit developer edition launched for Windows

Mozilla recently launched Firefox 36 for desktops and Android devices. And the 10th Firefox anniversary was celebrated by launching the 64-bit Firefox Developer Edition 38 for Windows.

The version can be downloaded now from the Firefox Developer Edition page. The new version for Windows can run larger applications faster and it maintains a high security standard too. The browser is limited to 4GB of address space. In its blog post, Mozilla said that heap sizes in



Apple launches ResearchKit framework to help medical research

At the launch of Apple Watch, a new software framework was announced by the company. This is expected to turn 700 million iPhones into medical diagnostic tools. This is an open source framework, called ResearchKit. It will allow medical researchers to create diagnostic apps to tap into the screens and accelerometers on the iPhone, and also tap data from HealthKit apps. The first five apps built with the open source framework have been made available and will help diagnose several kinds of disorders.

At the event, details of the special applications were provided by Apple's senior VP of operations, Jeff Williams. These applications include the mPower app, which can gauge the effects of Parkinson's disease. This app has been developed jointly by the University of Rochester, Xuanwu Hospital at Capital Medical University in Beijing, and Sage Bionetworks. On stage at the launch of Apple Watch, some tests within the app were demonstrated by Williams. These showed how the app could measure hand tremors by using an iPhone touchscreen, vocal trembling by using the microphone and also walking balance.

The ResearchKit framework is expected to help several problems faced during medical research, and the apps are built to be quite interactive too. The other apps mentioned include a diabetes diagnostic app from Massachusetts General Hospital, a heart disease diagnostic app from Stanford and the University of Oxford, an asthma health app from Mount Sinai Hospital and Weill Cornell Medical College, and an app to help victims of breast cancer, made by the Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, UCLA School of Public Health, Penn Medicine and Sage Bionetworks. Williams also said that sensitive data will be visible only to medical researchers and that, "Apple will not see your data."